

hunter-gatherer People who get their food by gathering plants or hunting animals rather than through settled farming

Ice Age Period of time when the world is much colder, and many parts are covered in glaciers

kindling Dry, thin sticks of wood that can take the fire from the tinder and turn it into a bigger flame

knapping Process of creating stone tools by striking stone to remove material

megafauna Large animals such as elephants, woolly mammoth, and giant sloths. Many Stone Age megafauna are extinct today

megalithic Any structure made by using very large stones such as Stonehenge or Göbekli Tepe

meteorite Pieces from space that land on Earth. Some meteorites are made of solid metal and Stone Age people used them to make tools

microlith Small stone tools used to make the points for spears and arrows

Neanderthal These were our closest relatives and they died out 24,000 years ago

Neolithic Time period after the Mesolithic when humans began growing crops and raising animals

obsidian Type of volcanic rock that is extremely glassy and very sharp and was used to make cutting tools and ornaments

ochre Mineral that has a vivid color and is used for paint and dye when mixed with fat

Palaeolithic Longest time period of the Stone Age when humans learned how to make stone tools, fire, and hunt

scraper Simple stone tool used for scraping animal skins or wood to smooth them down

shaman Priest or spiritual leader who has special powers and uses these to guide their people on important matters



Microliths attached to a harpoon tip

soft hammer Softer than a hard hammer, and often made of antler or wood, it allows a knapper to make a more precise and thin stone tool

spear thrower Tool for throwing a spear or dart a great distance with accuracy. The thrower acts as an extension of your arm giving you more power

thatching Technique for making a waterproof roof out of grasses and reeds.

tinder Thin material that easily catches fire

tusk Long tooth that grows from the jaws of animals such as warthogs, elephants, and mammoths. Sometimes called ivory, it can be carved easily and used to make jewelry and sculptures

Wolverine Ferocious animal that is in the weasel family and mainly scavenges meat. Wolverines appear frequently in Stone Age art